had a spectacular impact on India's international trade. The Jains around Jamnagar on the other hand engaged in agriculture and left for East Africa amidst social ostracism.[64] Away from the gaze of the Jain community in Gujarat, they would rise to produce several business tycoons in East Africa by the end of the 20th century. According to one family member of the Chandaria business group in Kenya:[65]

> The Oswal Jains of Jamnagar migrated to East Africa in the beginning of the 20th century . . . At home, we eat business, drink business, we talk business at the breakfast table, at lunch, at [the] dinner table. It is a penetrating induction, and is backed up by a much bigger capital base for our young ones to start from.

Business success was closely tied up with migration of families through kinship, a pattern observed across different communities in Gujarat.

The migration of Bhatias and Lohanas, two other prominent business-oriented communities of Gujarat, tracks closely with that of the Jains in recent times. Both claim descent from warrior castes in north-western India, migrations to Sindh to escape invasions, and later movements into Kachchh and Saurashtra in Gujarat.[66] The timing and exact nature of these movements is uncertain, but by the late 16th century the Bhatias had converted to Pushtimargi Vaishnavism, a Hindu sect started by Vallabhacharya that placed less taboo on overseas travel and adopted commercial occupations. Their presence was noted in Muscat, Aden and Zanzibar in the subsequent centuries with trading bases at the Mundra and Mandvi ports. The overseas migration of Lohanas started later. In the interim, their internal migration led to shopkeeping and moneylending activities within Gujarat. A migration stream to Poona to finance the activities of the Peshwa court in the 18th century has also been documented.[67] But the major destinations for the Lohanas and Bhatias in the 19th and early 20th century were Bombay and East Africa. In both cases, the migrants were drawn heavily from Kachchh.

For long, Kachchh had hosted a vibrant culture of trade, banking, insurance and shipbuilding, consistently patronized by rulers over many centuries.[68] In the second half of the 18th century, the Kachchh fleet